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Bazaar

OnePlus X

X marks the spot?

Can design trump specifications in the Indian market? The OnePlus X may be the first phone to take that question head on. It costs Rs. 16,999 and takes a completely different turn OnePlus has been doing so far. If the OnePlus 2 and OnePlus One strived to bring the most jaw dropping specs to price ratio, the OnePlus X has one focus, and that is design.

It has glass on both the back and front, and a metal frame to boot, which together provide a very premium look and feel. The OnePlus X's strength though, is also amongst its weaknesses. Firstly, glass on both sides means there's more to break. In addition, the rear panel is also quite fingerprint sensitive. The good thing though is that the OnePlus X is a 5 inch phone done right. It's only 5.5 inches tall, which is about the same size as the iPhone 6S. So, if you're a compact phone lover, this would be the best device for you.

While many smartphone makers today go for AMOLED displays, for OnePlus X, this is more of a design choice. The AMOLED has one task here, and that is to deliver the deepest blacks that it can. It makes the display blend into the bezels, making the phone look and feel that much better. In addition, the FHD display is sharp enough and the colours pop.

Another strength of the OnePlus X is in its camera. The 13MP camera on the back does really well in terms of colour reproduction, shutter response and speed of focus, but lacks details. Unless you're in the habit of zooming into your images, this shouldn't matter to you, and the colour reproduction and other pros of the camera really do make up for the lack of details. To make it easier, the OnePlus X has a better camera than the Meizu MX5 and the OnePlus One, and is really close to what the Moto X Style can provide.



Price
₹16,999

On the battery front, the phone has a 2525 mAh battery, which on regular usage can last you for about 10-12 hours, depending on how often you use the battery saver modes. On heavy usage, with more gaming than usual, the battery lasted us for less than 7 hours. While this is fine for day to day functionality, since you would usually get to charge the phone at least once every 10 hours, we still wait for the day when Android phones can last at least a full day.

Lastly, the elephant in the room. The OnePlus X runs on the Snapdragon 801 SoC, which though good, is massively outdated now. This means that your phone isn't future proof. For example, the Snapdragon 801 isn't a 64-bit capable processor, which means that it won't be able to take advantage

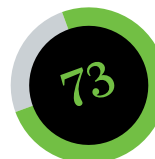
of Lollipop's 64-bit computing capabilities.

While the processor does provide good enough performance for day to day usage, you would ideally want a newer processor on your device. Also, the OnePlus X is prone to some stutters and crashes, which are because of the still buggy OxygenOS.

Another issue with the OnePlus X is that it has 16GB of internal storage. Even though you get 128GB of expandable storage, Android phones today need at least 32GB of internal storage. With things like music and movie streaming, an SD card can hamper the overall performance of a phone, and 16GB is just not enough storage for a phone to last long enough.

All in all though, the OnePlus X is a good phone, meant for those who have a sub-20k budget and want a phone that looks and feels good. It's all about the design here, and as long as you're fine with the older SoC and low internal storage, this smartphone should suit you well. If you want more storage though, the Moto X Play has a slightly better camera and comes with 32GB of internal storage. It doesn't look as good though.

Prasid Banerjee



Feature	75
Performance.....	65
Design	87
Value	67

Specifications

Display: 5 inch FHD; **SoC:** Qualcomm Snapdragon 801; **RAM:** 3GB; **Camera:** 13MP rear, 8MP front; **Storage:** 16GB expandable to 128GB; **Battery:** 2525 mAh

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